

It's traditional

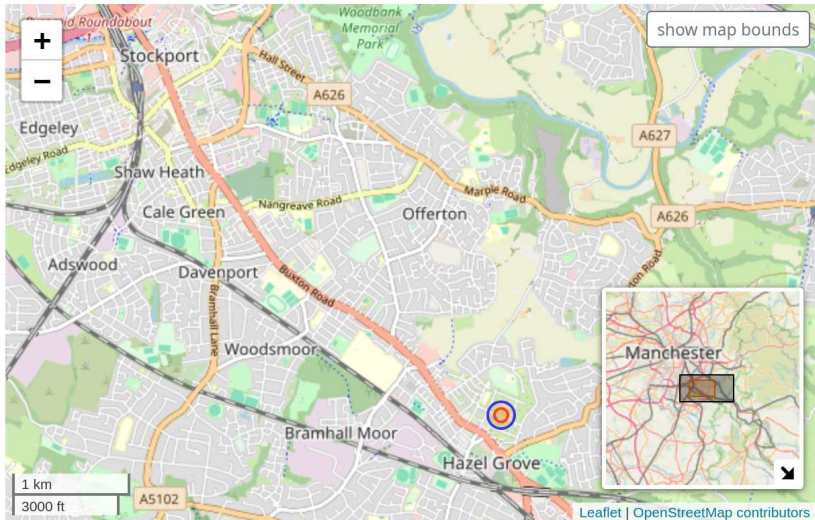
Boundaries and Places in the UK

Sarah Hoffmann
lonvia@denofr.de

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State of the Map Europe 2025
Dundee

Where am I?



OSM answer: address node

Way: 13 Douglas Road (323707543)

Version #2

Specify building types

Edited almost 3 years ago by Katy H

Changeset #128889793

Tags

addr:housenumber	13
addr:street	Douglas Road
building	semidetached_house

Nodes

▼ 5 nodes

- ▣ 3304874470 (part of ways 323707526, 323707529, and 11 Douglas Road (322926325))
- ▣ 3297122774
- ▣ 3297122826
- ▣ 3304874466 (part of ways 323707526, 323707529, and 11 Douglas Road (322926325))
- ▣ 3304874470 (part of ways 323707526, 323707529, and 11 Douglas Road (322926325))



Suburb?
City?
County?
State?

More complete answer

Ban Car Hotel

+441346532578

info@ban-carhotel.co.uk

Main Road, Lonmay, Fraserburgh, Aberdeenshire,
AB43 8RL, United Kingdom

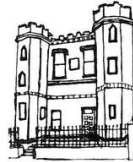


The Old Bowling Green

Winster

Find Us

East Bank, Winster, Matlock, Derbyshire DE4 2DS.



**The Berwick
Watchtower Gallery**

Contact

79 West End

Tweedmouth

Berwick upon Tweed

Northumberland

TD15 2HE

CONTACT US

Address: Talmage House - 55 Fosbury, Marlborough. Wilts, SN8 3NJ. United Kingdom

What OSM has

- relations of type `boundary=administrative`
- areas and nodes of type `place=*`
- other boundaries

Administrative boundary - Level 4



- ✓ well known
- ✓ consistent with human place perception

≈ **State**

Administrative boundary - Level 5



human place known as *London*



otherwise purely administrative (?)

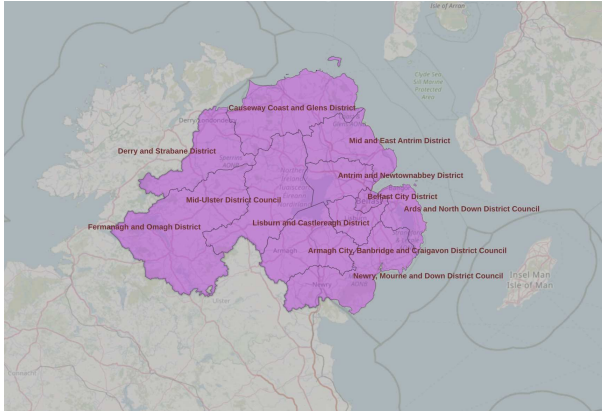
Administrative boundary - Level 6



? looks reasonable for larger cities like York

- ✗ occasionally cuts through settlements

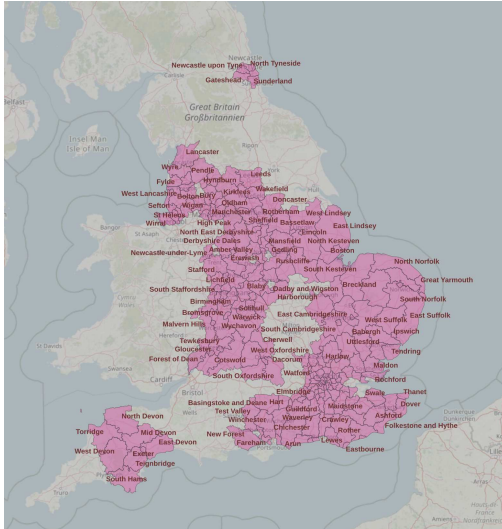
Administrative boundary - Level 7



X purely administrative

Northern Ireland only

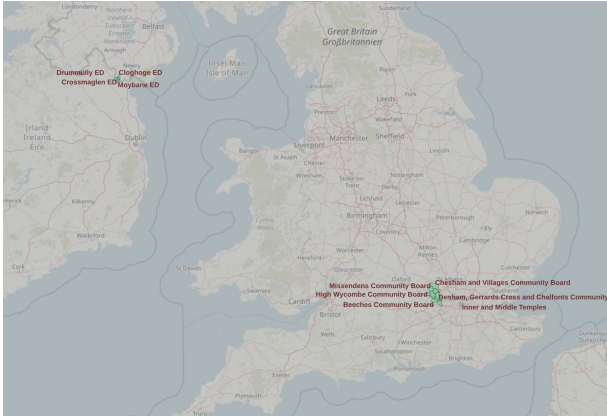
Administrative boundary - Level 8



- ✗ districts, purely administrative
- ✗ patchy coverage
- ✓ London boroughs
- ? Newcastle area looks reasonable

England only

Administrative boundary - Level 9



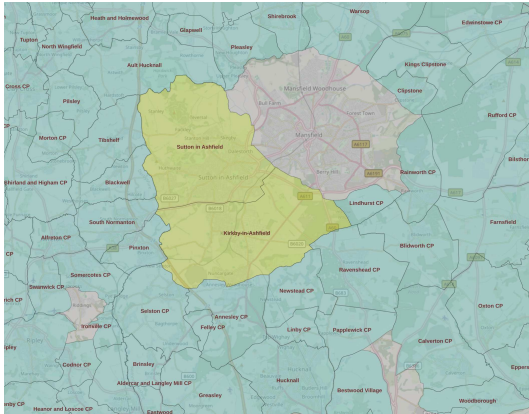
X purely administrative

Administrative boundary - Level 10



- ✓ good coverage of parishes for the English and Welsh country-side (village level)
- ? townlands for Northern Ireland (neighbourhood-level)
- ✗ unclear usage for Scotland

Administrative boundary - Level 11



x needs cleanup

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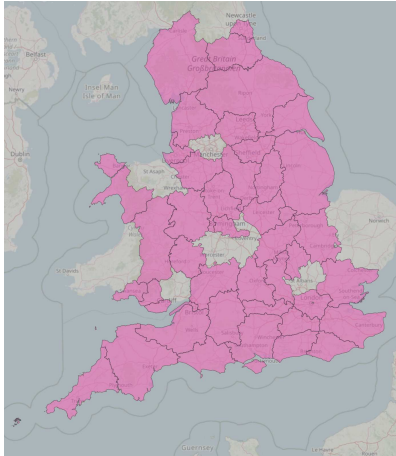
Administrative boundary - Summary

- useful areas on admin levels 5, 6(?), 8, 10 but not complete
- lots of extra tags (designation, borough, majory, ...)
- counties are gone completely

Other boundary types

historic	833	3.25%		✓	A historic administrative boundary (use judiciously).
political	610	2.38%		✓	Political boundary, such as an electoral ward or parliamentary constituency.
protected_area	436	1.70%		✓	Used to mark boundaries of protected areas including national parks, wilderness, marine protection areas
civil_parish	340	1.33%		-	
place	277	1.08%		✓	The boundaries of a key:place, when these boundaries can be defined but these are not administrative b
historic_parish	262	1.02%		-	
registrars_district	173	0.68%		-	
barony	75	0.29%		-	
traditional	55	0.21%		-	
fire	50	0.20%		-	
ceremonial	47	0.18%		-	
statistical	47	0.18%		✓	An official boundary recognised by government for statistical purposes.
vice_county	30	0.12%		✓	
superintendent_registr...	30	0.12%		-	
planning	20	0.08%		-	
historic:administrative	19	0.07%		-	
maritime	14	0.05%		✓	Maritime boundaries under the UN Convention on the Law of the Sea which are not administrative bound
poor_law_union	14	0.05%		-	
census	13	0.05%		✓	A census-designated boundary delineating a statistical area, not necessarily observable on the ground.
historic_diocese	8	0.03%		-	

Potential county boundaries

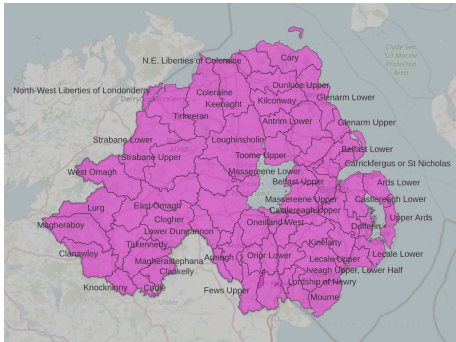


boundary=ceremonial



boundary=traditional

Potential boundaries: Northern Ireland



boundary=barony



```
boundary=civil_parish
```

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Questions

- ① What kind of places are relevant for human place perception in the UK?
- ② How can we make this more findable for data users?
- ③ How could we handle fuzzy place perception?
- ④ address tagging?

Nominatim's wish list

- computable using a handful of rules and reasonable effort
- as little country-specific knowledge as possible
- must work for England, Scotland, Wales, Northern Ireland
- must work equally in London and in the Scottish Highlands
- uses areas where possible
- should include all places that appear in the official address, as well as, commonly used place references